

Board 1

North Deals
None Vul

♠ K Q J 10
♥ J 9 6 4
♦ 6 3 2
♣ K 3

♠ 9 5 2
♥ 2
♦ A Q 10 9 8 7 5
♣ 8 7

N
W S
E

♠ 6 4 3
♥ A 10 5
♦ K 4
♣ Q J 10 6 2

♠ A 8 7
♥ K Q 8 7 3
♦ J
♣ A 9 5 4

You dealt this hand.

You estimate you can win 6 ♦ tricks so you open 3 ♦. Everybody passes.

West	North	East	South
	3 ♦		
All Pass			
3 ♦ by North			
Lead: ♣Q			

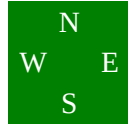
Board 2

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 9 2
♥ K J 8 5
♦ K J 9
♣ K Q 8 3

♠ A 3
♥ Q 10 4 2
♦ 8 4 2
♣ A J 6 2



♠ K Q J 10 8 6 4
♥ 9 7
♦ 6 5
♣ 10 4

♠ 7 5
♥ A 6 3
♦ A Q 10 7 3
♣ 9 7 5

The bidding has been as shown.

You have 13 points and if partner had opened with a 1 ♠ bid you'd be feeling "jumpy". But what a preemptive bidder needs from dummy are immediate winners, not points. So you pass.

Here's a pretty good tip: When partner opens with a 3-bid and you are trying to decide whether to take him to game, visualize him holding this very hand: K Q J 10 x x x of trumps and nothing in any other suit. Then base your decision on that.

*West**North**East**South*

3 ♠

All Pass

3 ♠ by East

Lead: ♥ A

Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 5 2

♥ 9

♦ A K Q 10 6 3

♣ J 5 3

♠ J 9 8 7 3

♥ A 4 2

♦ 8 2

♣ A K 7



♠ K Q 6 4

♥ K 5

♦ J 4

♣ Q 10 9 8 4

♠ A

♥ Q J 10 8 7 6 3

♦ 9 7 5

♣ 6 2

*West**North**East**South*

Pass

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by South

Lead: ♦K

You dealt this hand.

You expect your hand to produce 5 ♥ tricks and the ♠A. So you open 3♥. Partner responds 4♥.

When you preempted 3♥ you described your hand perfectly. You have nothing more to say except pass.

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ 8 3		♠ Q J 4 2	
♥ K Q 10 8 7 4 2		♥ 6	
♦ 8 6 2		♦ K Q J 5	
♣ 5		♣ J 10 6 2	
	N W E S		
		♠ A K 7 6	
		♥ J 5 3	
		♦ 9 4	
		♣ A 8 7 4	
		♠ 10 9 5	
		♥ A 9	
		♦ A 10 7 3	
		♣ K Q 9 3	

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
3♥	Pass	4♥	
All Pass			
4♥ by West			
Lead: ♦K			

The bidding has been as shown.

No matter how much we try to reduce bridge to rules and guidelines we will never get rid of the judgement factor. With this hand you definitely have 3 fast tricks for partner. In theory he can take 6 of his own, so 3♥ should be the right contract. BUT, maybe he could ruff a ♦ in your dummy?

Fortune favors the bold so you bid 4♥ . . . and live happily ever after.